



24-HOUR LLM BUILD SPRINT

Hack Armenia

Build an LLM system that can **evaluate** evidence, **reason** under uncertainty, and **generalize** — for Armenia's public interest.

August 8–9, 2026 · AI9 Startup Campus · Yerevan



AI9

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Welcome to Hack Armenia

One weekend. One theme. A working LLM system that actually does something useful for Armenia — and evidence that it works.



Build

24 hours to go from idea to a running prototype, with mentors in the room.



Measure

Show numbers. An evaluation — even a lightweight one — is what separates the top teams.



Pitch

5 minutes in front of an expert jury on Sunday. Talk plus live demo.

The sprint in numbers

24h

of building
Sat 10:00 → Sun

60—80

participants
one cohort

15—20

teams
3—4 people each

12

mentors
on-site Saturday

9

jury members
judging Demo Day

9

domains
Armenia's public interest

The theme: Armenia's public interest

Nothing is revealed at kickoff — the theme *is* the brief. Pick a real problem that matters here, and build for it.

Evaluate

Weigh evidence and cite what it is grounded in.

Reason

Work through uncertainty instead of guessing confidently.

Generalize

Hold up across real cases, not just your happy path.

The domains and example projects that follow are there to guide you — bring your own idea in the same spirit.

Nine public-interest domains

Where LLMs can be genuinely useful to Armenia. Choose one — or bring your own.



Urban development

City ops, planning & mobility



Public systems & policy

Filings, evidence & transparency



Healthcare

Safe triage, admin & patient education



Education

Tutoring, grading & Armenian-language learning



Security

Phishing defense, secure code & threat triage



Food & agriculture

Crop advisory, food safety & nutrition



Environment & energy

Efficiency, hazards & resources



Finance & fintech

Fair credit, fraud & literacy



Emergency & disaster

Coordination, preparedness & response

Example projects

Starting points, not requirements. Full list on the website.



SME tax-filing copilot

Walk a small business through declarations; extract figures from receipts and pre-fill the forms.



Guarded symptom triage

Route symptoms to the right level of care in Armenian — with hard safety rails. Not diagnosis.



Auto-grading assistant

Grade short answers against a rubric, write feedback, and flag borderline cases for the teacher.



Phishing & scam detector

Catch bank-impersonation SMS and fake government notices aimed at Armenian users.



Crop advisory agent (VLM)

Diagnose plant disease from a photo and advise on treatment and timing, in Armenian.



Response coordination agent

Turn chaotic incoming incident reports into a de-duplicated, prioritised response picture.

Rules & tools



Any model or API

Open or closed, local or hosted. Bring your own keys where you can.



Open source required

Projects must be open source and fully reproducible. No closed black boxes.



Armenian encouraged

Not required, but Armenian-language support is a real plus.



Use real data

Anything publicly available, or data we provide before or during the event.



Teams of 3–4

Form your team at kickoff. 15–20 teams in total.



Build it here

Come with ideas, not with a finished codebase. The work happens during the sprint.

The 24 hours

Sat 10:00

Kickoff & briefing

Welcome, theme walkthrough, logistics.

Sat 11:00

Teams form & plan

Form a team of 3–4, scope your problem and data.

Sat 15:00–18:00

Mentors on-site

Mentors available in the room — flexible, drop in any time.

Sat → Sun

Build

Prototype end-to-end early, then harden and evaluate.

Sun 12:00

Code freeze

Lock the repo, prepare your talk and demo.

Sun 13:00

Demo Day

5-minute pitches to the jury.

After demos

Awards

The jury names the winners.

Your mentors

On-site **Saturday 15:00–18:00** — flexible, drop in any time.



Philipp Guevorguian

Technical Staff · Perceptron AI



Aram Shakhbandaryan

Founder · Empty.ai



Ani Vanyan

ML Researcher · YerevaNN



Khoren Petrosyan

ML Researcher · YerevaNN



Naré Gevorgyan

CEO · AICA



Marie Mikayelyan

CPO · OmniShift



**Hovhannes
Kuloghlyan**

Co-Founder · Wirestock



Armen Grigoryan

Head of TV & Digital Products ·
Ucom



Khachik Badeyan

Technical Portfolio Lead · PMI
Science Armenia



Gevorg Minasyan

Async



Davit Karamyan

NVIDIA



Tigran Atoyan

Founder & AI Researcher

How to use your mentors

Come with a specific question

“Is this evaluation sound?” beats “what do you think of our idea?”. Mentors are most useful once you have something concrete.

Show them something running

Even a broken prototype gives a mentor more to work with than a slide.

Ask about scope

The most common 24-hour failure is building too much. Mentors will help you cut.

Product and technical both

Some mentors will push on your model and evaluation, others on who actually uses this and why.

Mentors are on-site Saturday 15:00–18:00. Timing is flexible — grab whoever is free.

What you hand in



Working demo

It has to run. A rough end-to-end demo beats a polished deck.



Artifact

A repo with reproducible code — plus an app link if you have one.



Evaluation

A test set, rubric, examples, or benchmark — with numbers.



Impact note

Who uses it, and what changes if it works.

Code freeze is Sunday 12:00 — lock the repo and prepare your pitch before then.

The pitch: 5 minutes, maximum

Five minutes total per team, split however you like between the talk and the demo.



The talk

The problem, why an LLM is the right tool, how you evaluated it, and what you found — including where it breaks.



The demo

Show it running on a real case. Live is best; a recording is fine if the network is not.

Split it as you see fit — but at 5:00 you stop. Practise it once before you present.

How you are judged

One rubric for every team, whatever domain you pick.

1

Idea quality & fit

Does it target a real Armenian public-interest problem worth solving?

2

Evaluation & evidence

Did you actually test the system and show results — not just assert them?

3

Model limits & safety

Do you know where the model fails, and how you mitigate it?

4

Real-world plausibility

Could this work outside the demo — realistic data, reproducible, deployable?

What judges look for



A working prototype

Judges want to see it run, not just slides.



An evaluation method

Even lightweight. “It seems to work” is not evidence.



Failure modes & safety

Name where it breaks and who it could harm. Show your guardrails.



Realistic data

Toy data that ignores messy reality will not convince.



The LLM earns its place

If a regex or a plain form would do the job, use that instead.

The jury

Who you present to on Sunday at 13:00.



Gevorg Mantashyan

First Deputy Minister · Ministry of
High-Tech Industry



David Zokhrabyan

Growth · OpenAI



Davit Arakelyan

Chief Business Officer · Eleveight AI



Arik Akhverdyan

Co-Founder & CEO · AI9



Vazgen Hakobjanyan

Founder & CEO · Magical Labs



Vazgen Badalyan

Founder · Evidenso



Erik Arakelyan

Senior Researcher · NVIDIA Armenia



Marie Mikayelyan

CPO · OmniShift



Arto Yeritsyan

CEO & Founder · Async

The organizers

Hack Armenia is run by the Armenia LLM Summer School, AI9 and YerevaNN.



Armen Aghajanyan

Perceptron AI



Aram Galstyan

USC / Amazon



Erik Arakelyan

Senior Researcher · NVIDIA Armenia



Hrant Khachatryan

Founding Director · YerevaNN



Perouz Taslakian

ServiceNow AI Research



Tatev Vardanyan

YerevaNN



Arik Akhverdyan

Co-Founder & CEO · AI9



Roza Khachatryan

COO · AI9 Startup Campus



Prizes

OpenAI is sponsoring the hackathon prizes with API credits.



1st place

\$12,000

in OpenAI API credits



2nd place

\$7,500

in OpenAI API credits



3rd place

\$5,000

in OpenAI API credits

1st prize

1st PRIZE

\$12 000

in OpenAI API credits

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2nd prize

2nd PRIZE

\$7500

in OpenAI API credits

OpenAI

AI9 startup
campus



3rd prize

3rd PRIZE

\$5 000

in OpenAI API credits

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Supported by



Ministry of High-Tech Industry

Hack Armenia is generously supported by the Ministry of High-Tech Industry of the Republic of Armenia.



ISAA

Supporting the sprint alongside the Ministry.

Special prize

A separate award, presented by Eleveight AI.



\$5,000 equivalent GPUs

Eleveight AI is presenting its own special prize at Hack Armenia — GPUs worth \$5,000, so the winning team leaves with real compute to keep building.

NOW GO BUILD

Good luck

Ship something that runs, measure it honestly, and tell us who it helps.

Demo Day — Sunday 13:00 · armeniallm@gmail.com



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